GR-019
Recruiter Judgment-Building Path

How judgment develops when AI takes more of the entry-level work

Prepared by GiGi Garcia for discussion with Timothy King | November 2026

Working principle: If AI removes the work people historically learned through, we have to deliberately replace the learning value of that work - not assume judgment will develop on its own.

Why this matters

Recruiting is a good test case for this problem. As AI takes on more sourcing, first-pass screening, ranking, candidate summaries, and administrative preparation, some of the repetitive work that helped early-career recruiters build pattern recognition begins to disappear.

That is efficient, but it creates a development risk. Recruiters still need to make sound calls when the case is ambiguous, when the AI recommendation is incomplete or biased, and when a selection or rejection decision has real human and legal consequences. If the learning work changes, the development path has to change with it.

My goal is not to recreate manual work just to preserve an old career path. It is to make sure we do not remove the experiences that built judgment without replacing them with something equally deliberate and credible.

Proposed judgment-building progression

Observe	Explain	Challenge	Decide with supervision	Decide independently	Coach others

1. Observe

The Recruiter watches experienced practitioners make candidate decisions and sees how they weigh context, identify risk, handle ambiguity, and decide when a recommendation needs more scrutiny.

2. Explain

The Recruiter has to explain the reasoning behind an AI-supported screening or ranking result instead of simply accepting it. The focus is on why a candidate advanced, did not advance, or needs a closer look.

3. Challenge

The Recruiter is intentionally given cases where the AI output is incomplete, overly confident, inconsistent, or missing context. The Recruiter must identify the issue and explain why the recommendation should be questioned.

4. Decide with supervision

The Recruiter begins making selection and rejection decisions with review from an experienced Recruiter, the Director of TA, or another designated decision owner. Feedback should focus on the quality of the reasoning, not just whether both people reached the same answer.

5. Decide independently

Once judgment is demonstrated consistently, the Recruiter receives greater decision authority, including the ability to accept, reject, pause, override, or escalate AI-supported recommendations when appropriate.

6. Coach others

The strongest evidence that judgment is becoming durable is the ability to explain it to someone else. Experienced Recruiters should eventually coach newer practitioners on candidate evaluation, bias, exceptions, escalation, and responsible use of AI-supported recommendations.

What should replace the lost learning experience

- Structured review of strong and poor hiring decisions, including what was missed and what happened afterward.
- Supervised review of AI-ranked candidate slates rather than passive acceptance of the ranking.
- Bias and adverse-impact scenarios that force the Recruiter to identify where a seemingly efficient recommendation creates risk.
- Exposure to ambiguous and exception cases - not only routine, clean examples.
- Calibration sessions with experienced Recruiters and the Director of TA to compare reasoning and decision standards.
- Review of downstream outcomes so Recruiters can see the consequence of earlier selection decisions.
- A requirement to explain why an AI recommendation was accepted, challenged, overridden, or escalated.
- Progressive decision authority as the Recruiter demonstrates stronger judgment.

What good judgment should look like

By the time a Recruiter is operating independently, I would expect them to be able to:

- recognize when an AI-supported recommendation is incomplete, biased, or misleading;
- explain the reasoning behind a candidate decision in plain language;
- distinguish a routine case from an exception that deserves more scrutiny;
- challenge or override an AI recommendation when the evidence does not support it;
- know when escalation is required and who should receive it;
- make an independent decision under ambiguity rather than defaulting to the system;
- understand the human, legal, and organizational consequences of a poor selection decision; and
- coach another practitioner through the same reasoning.

How I would use this as the GR-019 pilot

I would use the Recruiter role as the first GR-019 pilot because it gives us a clear before-and-after view: AI can absorb more of the sourcing and screening work, while the human still carries consequential selection judgment.

The test is not whether every Recruiter follows the exact same training program. The test is whether the framework can require a credible alternative path for building judgment whenever the old experience ladder is disrupted by AI.

If this works, the same pattern can be adapted later for other roles - with different cases, different consequences, and different decision rights - without reinventing the core principle each time.

GR-019 working position

When AI removes the work people used to learn through, judgment development has to become more intentional. The framework should be able to name that alternative path before we assume the role is ready for a more AI-supported future.